

awarded a state pension, which gave him more time for composition. He was able to give up his violin post in 1905 (from this time, he sometimes conducted the orchestra, and was its official conductor from 1908 to 1914). In 1906, he had another resounding success with his high-spirited comic opera *Maskarade*, which remains popular in Denmark. His other work includes incidental music for the stage, chamber and choral works, and numerous songs.

An enduring reputation

However, Nielsen's reputation rests mainly on his major orchestral works—six symphonies and three concertos (for violin, clarinet, and flute). His symphonic output begins in a late-Romantic sound-world that would have been recognizable to Brahms but becomes increasingly Modernist, encompassing violent conflict and quirky humor as well as melodic richness, all within a rough-edged, earthy vigor.

Nielsen's 60th birthday was marked by national celebration in Denmark. The next year he had a heart attack, but continued to work. In 1931, he was appointed director of the Copenhagen Conservatory, but he died nine months later. A monument to him by his wife was erected in Copenhagen in 1939. In his lifetime, his reputation was mainly confined to Denmark and neighboring Sweden, but since the 1950s it has spread worldwide.